

Golden Quadrilateral

It is a network of highways that connect the four major metropolitan cities of the country in the four directions – Delhi (North), Chennai (South), Kolkata (East) and Mumbai (West) – thus forming a quadrilateral and hence the name **"Golden Quadrilateral"**. The project was launched in 2001 and put into operation in January 2012. The Golden Quadrilateral project included construction of new express highways, including renovation and extension of the existing highways to four or six lanes.

Major highlights of the Golden Quadrilateral

- It is the largest highway project completed in India.
- It is the fifth longest highway project in the world.
- The overall length of the Golden quadrilateral is 5,646km.
- The Golden Quadrilateral passes through 13 states of India.
- It constitutes only the national highways of the country and not state highways and rural-urban roadways.
- The project cost was ₹. 60,000 crores.

The Golden Quadrilateral project provides faster transport networks between major cities and ports. It provides smoother movement of goods and people within India. It enables industrial development and job development in smaller towns through access to markets. Farmers are able to transport their produce through better transportation. It has enormously increased the economic growth of the country.

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